

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 1/12: The Deccan as a connected but frictional field

FIELD -> plateau + ghats + Narmada-Tapti routes + Konkan/Coromandel links

STATES -> Ahmadnagar + Bijapur + Golconda + Bidar/Berar remnants

GATEWAY -> Faruqi Khandesh/Burhanpur/Asirgarh; not a Bahmani successor

MOBILITY -> traders + pilgrims + Sufis + soldiers + diplomats

FRICTION -> distance + monsoon + rivers + fodder + fortified corridors

METHOD -> map route/fort/market/local elite, not north-versus-south blocs

BOUNDARY -> full Vijayanagara/Bahmani Topic 09; later war Topic 23

MUST REMEMBER: Ahmadnagar, Bijapur, Golconda and Malik Ambar anchor the Mughal-Deccan sequence to the stated 1657 boundary.

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 2/12: Deccan chronology 1562-1657

1562-76 -> early Khandesh contact; 1576 submission
1591 -> embassies | 1596 -> Berar | 1600 -> Ahmadnagar fort
1601 -> Asirgarh/Khandesh + surviving Nizam Shahi remnant
1610 reversal | 1616-21 recoveries | 1624 Bhatnuri | 1626 Ambar dies
1633 -> Daulatabad/dynastic extinction | 1636 -> twin ahdnamas
1636-44 / 1652-57 -> Aurangzeb's two viceroyalties
1656 Golconda -> 1657 Bijapur; stop before succession/later annexation.

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 3/12: A spectrum of political relations

EMBASSY -> demand + warning + information, not equality

ALLIANCE -> contingent cooperation without permanent submission

TRIBUTE / INDEMNITY -> recurring / one-time payment

PROTECTION / ARBITRATION -> hierarchy while subordinate court survives

KHUTBA / SIKKA -> sovereign recognition, not uniform administration

OCCUPATION / ANNEXATION -> military possession / direct imperial claim

DURABLE CONTROL -> fort + supply + hasil + local cooperation + time.

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 4/12: Chand Bibi and the Ahmadnagar crisis

1595 -> Burhan/Ibrahim deaths -> rival claimants and noble coalitions

MIYAN MANJU -> Deccani coalition invites Mughals, then resists

CHAND BIBI -> infant Bahadur + Habshi support + Bijapur/Golconda appeal

1596 -> four-month defence -> Berar ceded + suzerainty + regency

1597 -> combined recovery attempt defeated in Berar theatre

1600 -> second siege + hostile-faction murder + fort captured

VERDICT: constrained regency and diplomacy, not lone romantic heroism.

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 5/12: Akbar's foothold and its limits

MOTIVES -> sovereignty + Khandesh route + revenue + instability

PORTUGUESE -> cartaz/pilgrim/coastal pressure; context, not sole cause

GAINS -> Berar + Balaghat + Ahmadnagar fort + Asirgarh/Khandesh

BASE -> Burhanpur links plateau, Malwa/Gujarat and Agra-Surat route

LIMIT -> Murtaza II/Nizam Shahi remnant recognized after 1600

LIMIT -> garrison and map claim do not secure countryside or revenue

VERDICT: strategic foothold and selective annexation, not whole Deccan.

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 6/12: Malik Ambar's resistance engine

LEGITIMACY -> restored Nizam Shahi claimant + Peshwa office

COALITION -> Habshi + Deccani + Afghan + Bijapuri aid + Maratha bargis

METHOD -> rapid movement + intelligence + plunder + supply-cutting

FISCAL -> later evidence: measure/boundaries/rates; ijara -> zabti type

URBAN -> Khirki and water/logistics support; material evidence bounded

LIMIT -> 1616/17/21 defeats + rivalry with Bijapur + no permanent rescue

DATE -> standard death 1626; one assigned OCR narrative prints 1627.

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 7/12: Why conquest did not equal consolidation

SIEGE POWER -> artillery + engineers + composite cavalry/infantry
STAYING POWER -> grain + fodder + powder + route + garrison + money
ECOLOGY -> plateau/ghats/rivers/monsoon multiply time and transport cost
LOCAL POWER -> desh mukh + record staff + fort-holder + service noble
FISCAL GAP -> assessed jama can exceed realized hasil
WAR LOOP -> disrupted cultivation -> lower revenue -> weaker coercion
RULE: victory becomes rule only through repeated fiscal-local integration.

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 8/12: Jahangir: recovery with restraint

1610 -> Akbari gains largely reversed outside secure bases

1611 -> converging armies fail through rivalry and coordination

1616 -> coalition defeated; Khirki occupied/burned

1617 -> Khurram pressure; Balaghat restored + fort key delivered

1621 -> territory/additional belt + indemnity restored

POLICY -> no enlarged annexation; Adil Shah called farzand

VERDICT: real military recovery plus deliberate limited commitment.

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 9/12: The pre-Shivaji Maratha bridge

ROLE -> bargi cavalry + deshमुख roots + revenue staff + diplomacy
SERVICE -> Ahmadnagar/Bijapur/Mughal employment and defection
MUGHAL RECRUIT -> Jagdev Rai + Babaji Kate + Udaji Ram + Bhonsales
SHAHJI -> Mughal mansab 5000/Poona jagir -> Fath Khan transfer -> defection
1633-36 -> claimant + Bijapuri troops + disbanded Nizam Shahi soldiers
LEGACY -> skill, local knowledge and confidence for later mobilization
LIMIT: no unified nationalist army or inevitable Shivaji state before 1657.

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 10/12: Daulatabad and the 1636 settlement

HARDENING -> Khan-i-Jahan asylum makes independent Ahmadnagar intolerable

1632 -> Fath Khan puppet + Mughal khutba/sikka + service

1633 -> Mahabat Khan takes Daulatabad; ruling dynasty ends

RESISTANCE -> Shahji raises claimant; Bijapur contests partition

BIJAPUR -> suzerainty + 20-lakh indemnity + arbitration + Shahji condition

GOLCONDA -> Shah Jahan khutba + tribute for protection

EXCHANGE -> Bijapur receives major former Ahmadnagar share

FORM -> partition + buffers + coercive hierarchy, not total annexation

BENEFIT -> lower direct cost and temporary stability

LIMIT -> compliance depends on trust, capacity and changing southern power.

CLOSE DISTINCTION: Campaign, treaty, tribute, elite defection and revenue logistics were linked but not interchangeable mechanisms.

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 11/12: Why the 1656-57 compact broke

POST-1636 -> Bijapur/Golconda expand into Karnataka/Coromandel

1646 -> Mughal-backed two-to-one sharing shows arbitration role

FISCAL -> Deccan deficit + inflated jama/weak hasil + subsidy dispute

1652-57 -> Aurangzeb/Murshid Quli seek revenue and territorial relief

MIR JUMLA -> Golconda rupture + Karnataka wealth + Mughal service

1656 -> compensation/tribute dispute + Ramgir; full annexation refused

BIJAPUR -> 1656 succession/arrears -> 1657 invasion

TERMS -> former Nizam Shahi lands surrendered; state not annexed

DEBATE -> Aurangzeb presses conquest; Dara's decisive role unproven

EFFECT -> 1636 trust broken; direct-rule cost dilemma unresolved.

EVIDENCE LIMIT: Imperial annexation claims must be separated from durable control and from the agency of Deccani states and elites.

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 12/12: Topic 18 final answer spine

DEFINE -> suzerainty != tribute != garrison != annexation != control
MAP -> states + Khandesh gateway + fort/route/market ecology
TRACE -> Akbar foothold -> Ambar -> Jahangir restraint -> 1636 buffers
APPLY -> viceroy + jagir/jama-hasil + local recruitment + logistics
CLOSE -> Mir Jumla/Golconda 1656 + Bijapur 1657; stop there
SOURCE -> Abu'l Fazl/Tuzuk/Padshahnama + Ferishta + Marathi/European/material
ADJ PYQ -> 2020 GS-I Q12 Persian sources | 2024 Prelims Q56 Bhatkal
DIRECT PYQ -> zero verified Topic-18 CSE routes, 2018-2026
VERDICT -> military leverage repeatedly outran durable fiscal-local control.